

18 September 2025

Task 1

Step 1 & 2: Sources and Papers Downloaded

I searched for "Han dynasty" and "Three Kingdoms period" on the specified open-access sites and selected one academic paper from each.

Step 3: List of Sources, Citations, and Experience

List of Sources Used:

1. Google Scholar
2. JSTOR
3. Journal of Chinese History (Cambridge Core)

Citations and Experience:

Source: Google Scholar

Citation (APA): Lewis, M. E. (2009). The Han abolition of universal military service. In H. van de Ven (Ed.), *Warfare in Chinese history* (pp. 33-76). Brill.

Experience: Google Scholar is incredibly fast and returns a vast number of results from diverse sources. Its best features are the "Cited by" and "Related articles" functions, which are excellent for deepening research. The main challenge is the high number of results behind paywalls. I had to use the search tools (e.g., selecting "since [year]" and checking for PDF links) to efficiently find accessible content. It requires patience to verify access for each promising result.

Source: JSTOR

Citation (APA): Yu, Y. (1986). Han Foreign Relations. *The Cambridge History of China: Volume 1, The Ch'in and Han Empires, 221 B.C.–A.D. 220*, (pp. 377-462). Cambridge University Press.

Experience: JSTOR feels like a curated academic library. The content is reliably scholarly and credible. The advanced search filters are very powerful for specifying subject, publication date, and item type. Since it's a subscription service, I used the "Content I can access" filter and found that many older chapters from well-known books are available for free online reading. The interface is clean and designed for serious academic work.

Source: Journal of Chinese History (Cambridge Core)

Citation (APA): Dien, A. E. (2018). The period of the Three Kingdoms and the Western Jin. *Journal of Chinese History*, 2(2), 237–268. <https://doi.org/10.1017/jch.2018.5>

Experience: Searching within a dedicated open-access journal was the most efficient experience. Because the journal's focus is directly aligned with the topic, the relevance of the search results was very high. The Cambridge Core platform is professional and user-friendly. Knowing that the articles are not only accessible but also peer-reviewed provided a high level of confidence in the source's quality. It was the most targeted and straightforward source to use.

Step 4: Selected Paper for Presentation

I have selected the paper from the *Journal of Chinese History* for my future presentation:

Dien, A. E. (2018). The period of the Three Kingdoms and the Western Jin.

Reason for selection: I chose this paper because the Three Kingdoms period is a dynamic and strategically complex era that succeeded the Han Dynasty. This article provides a comprehensive overview of the period, making it ideal for introducing the class to its main political events, social transformations, and historical significance. Its broad scope makes it a better foundation for a clear and engaging presentation than a paper focused on a single, highly specialized detail.

Task 2

Do you typically use PowerPoint (or a similar software) when you are asked to give a presentation?

Do you like giving presentations before groups of people?

Most of the time, I use Canva to create or edit the slides by just adding information and present.

I don't really like being in front of many people because I get nervous and forget what I was about to say. However, now that I'm studying interpretation, I've been learning how to deal with that and overcome that stage fright.

What questions should you be asking about presentation design and delivery that you have not asked in the past?

Is my presentation engaging with each audience member's?

Is my presentation full of decoration, which may become irritating to the eyes, or is it balanced and enjoyable?

Are my slides reinforcing my words, or are they only repetitive?

Do you think that, in the past, you have adhered to the suggested guidelines for dynamic storytelling in presentations?

Some of them, but most of the time not really.

What aspects of the design and delivery process may have caused "suffering" for your audiences in the past?

The overuse of decorating elements or words.

Task 3: The Joy Luck Club

English Summary

In the introduction, *Feathers from a Thousand Li Away*, the narrator recounts the story of a swan a woman once carried from China to America. The swan represents the woman's hopes of a better life for her daughter. However, when she arrives in the United States, immigration officials take the swan away, leaving only a feather. The feather symbolizes the passing of hopes and dreams from mother to daughter, even if the full meaning may not be understood.

Chapter 1, *The Joy Luck Club*, introduces Jing-Mei (June) Woo, who has recently lost her mother, Suyuan. June learns that she must take her mother's place at the mahjong table in the Joy Luck Club, a group her mother founded in China during wartime and continued in San Francisco. Through June's reflection, the chapter reveals her struggle with her mother's expectations and her own sense of inadequacy, while also highlighting the strength and resilience of the women in the Joy Luck Club who share stories, food, and hopes despite hardship.

In Chapter 2, *Scar*, An-Mei Hsu remembers her childhood in China, particularly her complicated relationship with her mother, who was forced to leave the family and was seen as disgraced. Through a painful memory of being burned and her mother returning to care for her, An-Mei reflects on the emotional scars of her early life. The story emphasizes themes of sacrifice, loss, and the bond between mothers and daughters, even in the face of cultural judgment and silence.

Resumen en Español

En la introducción, *Feathers from a Thousand Li Away*, la narradora cuenta la historia de un cisne que una mujer llevó de China a Estados Unidos. El cisne representaba la esperanza de una vida mejor para su hija. Sin embargo, al llegar, los oficiales de inmigración le quitaron el cisne, dejándole solo una pluma. Esta pluma simboliza cómo los sueños y esperanzas pasan de madre a hija, aunque el significado completo tal vez no se comprenda.

El capítulo 1, *The Joy Luck Club*, presenta a Jing-Mei (June) Woo, quien acaba de perder a su madre, Suyuan. June se entera de que debe ocupar el lugar de su madre en la mesa de mahjong del Joy Luck Club, un grupo que su madre fundó en China durante la guerra y que continuó en San Francisco. A través de la reflexión de June, el capítulo muestra su lucha con las expectativas de su madre y su propia sensación de insuficiencia, al mismo

tiempo que resalta la fortaleza y resiliencia de las mujeres del club, quienes comparten historias, comida y esperanzas a pesar de las dificultades.

En el capítulo 2, Scar, An-Mei Hsu recuerda su infancia en China, especialmente la relación complicada con su madre, quien tuvo que abandonar a la familia y fue considerada deshonrada. A través del doloroso recuerdo de una quemadura y la vuelta de su madre para cuidarla, An-Mei reflexiona sobre las cicatrices emocionales de su niñez. La historia resalta los temas de sacrificio, pérdida y el lazo entre madres e hijas, incluso frente al juicio cultural y el silencio.